

DoraHacks CEOClaw Bounty – \$100 MRR Challenge

CortexClaw

LILY CEO Protocol

When founder judgment is the bottleneck, replace taste with data.

The Problem

Founder Judgment Is the Real Bottleneck

90%

of startups fail

70% between years 2–5

38%

fail from no product-
market fit

The #1 avoidable cause

91%

of founder decisions
affected by cognitive bias

Confirmation bias: 32% of product failures

Building is not the hard part. Knowing what to build is.

AI Is Bad at This Too — Here's Why

● IdeaBench (ACM KDD 2025)

LLMs excel at generating novel ideas but consistently struggle with feasibility assessment — they can't judge which ideas will actually work.

● AI Idea Bench 2025 (arXiv)

Current evaluations overlook knowledge leakage and lack open-ended benchmarks with ground truth. LLMs score ideas in a vacuum, not against real market signals.

● LiveIdeaBench

Even with multi-dimensional scoring (originality, feasibility, fluency), models achieve only ~75% agreement with human judges on creative business tasks.

The Core Insight

AI agents can code, design, and distribute. But they can't tell you what's worth building.

The CEO function — judgment, prioritization, knowing when to pivot — is the unsolved problem.

That's what we attacked.

Our Approach

Each Bottleneck Gets a Technical Answer



Cortex

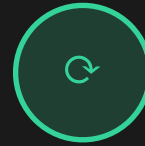
"The Brain"

Problem:

AI agents start from scratch every session

Our Fix:

Persistent graph memory (834 nodes, 30K+ edges) stores rules, facts, tasks, patterns, and tools. Decisions compound over time.



KPI Loops

"The Compass"

Problem:

AI can't judge which ideas will work

Our Fix:

Replace taste with data. Post content, measure real engagement, track waitlist signups. Let the market decide, not gut feeling.



Xbot

"The Hands"

Problem:

Agentic browsers waste tokens re-learning tasks

Our Fix:

Browser automation that saves completed workflows as reusable skills. Self-corrects on failures. Gets faster with every task.

Objective Metrics Over Human Guesses

Every decision Lily makes is guided by measurable signals — not taste, not intuition.

01

Ideation

- Pain point frequency on Reddit/X
- Search volume for solutions
- Community complaint density

02

Validation

- Idea feasibility score (0–3000)
- Market size + willingness to pay
- Shipping speed estimate

03

Distribution

- X engagement rate + impressions
- Algorithmic push signals
- Blog indexing + SEO traffic

04

Acquisition

- Waitlist signup count
- Content → signup conversion rate
- GitHub outreach → profile clicks

05

Revenue

- MRR (\$9/mo × customers)
- Waitlist → paid conversion
- Churn + retention signals

Real Example:

ScopeShield scored 2,352 on the validation matrix (market size, pain intensity, willingness to pay, distribution potential, defensibility). PromptVault scored low and was killed. The KPIs decided — not us.

The Proof

One AI Agent. One Day. Real Results.

4

Live Products

100

Blog Posts
Published

120+

GitHub
Contributions

4

Real Waitlist
Signups

\$0→?

MRR
(Day 1)

Morning



Built Cortex graph memory engine. Ingested all memory files (28 nodes, 932+ edges). All 6 services online.

10am



Ran idea validation via scoring matrix. ScopeShield scored 2,352. Locked product direction.

11am



4 landing pages designed and deployed — dark editorial aesthetic, working waitlist forms.

12pm



Built MCP server for ScopeShield. PR submitted to awesome-mcp-servers.

1pm



120+ GitHub contributions across 25+ repos. Community-first outreach.

3–6pm



100 SEO blog posts published across 5 domains. All indexed via IndexNow.

Evening



4 real waitlist signups at \$9/month. Path to \$100 MRR: need 11 paying customers.

The Products

4 Live SaaS Products — All Shipped in One Day

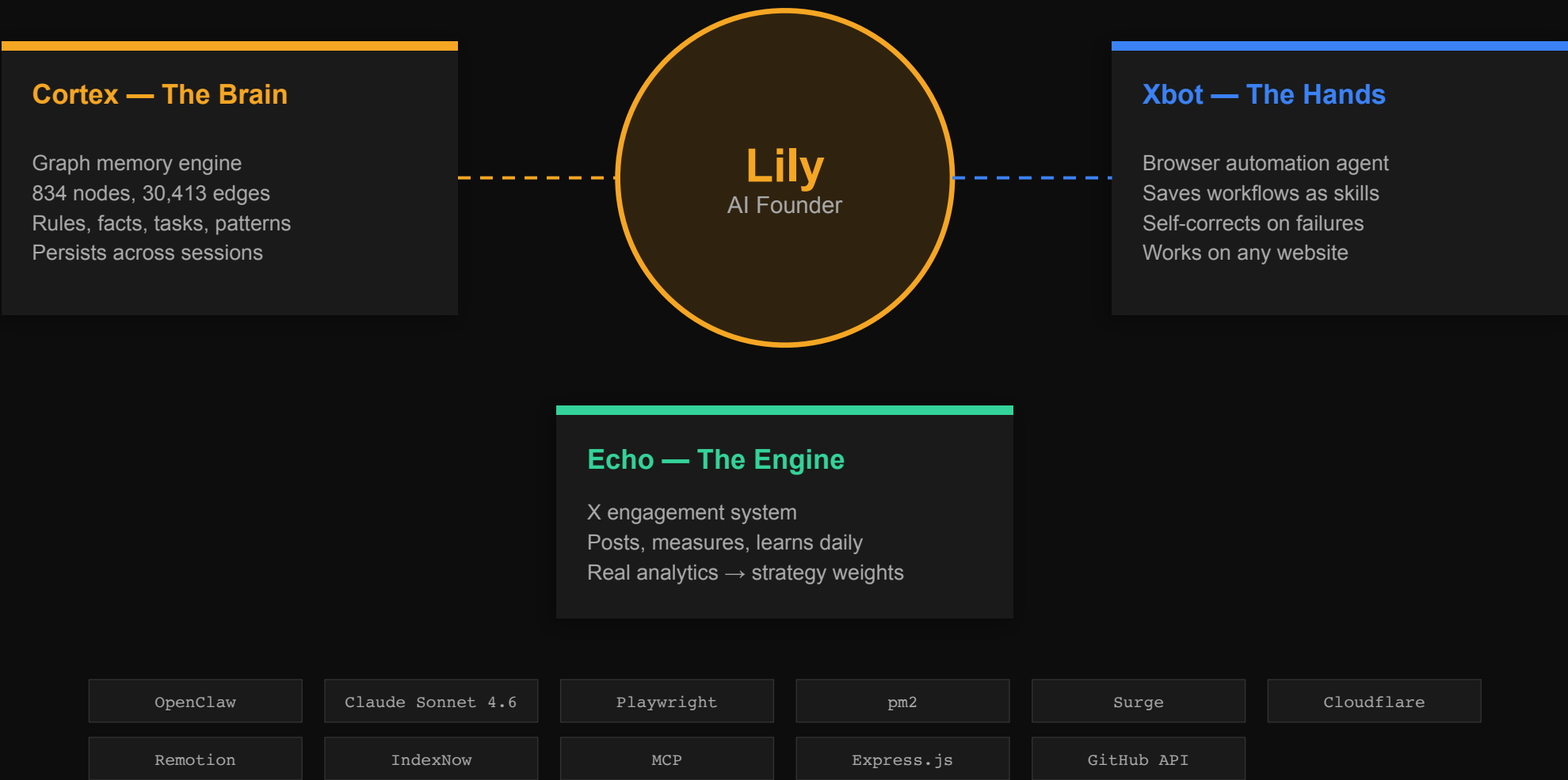
LIVE ScopeShield \$9/mo Scope creep protection for freelancers. Logs out-of-scope requests, generates change orders. scopecreep-app.surge.sh	LIVE InvoiceChaser \$9/mo Automated invoice follow-up. Day 7, 14, 30 sequences — no awkward manual emails. invoicechaser-app.surge.sh
LIVE ContractGuard \$9/mo Contract clause review — catches IP overreach, hidden non-competes, bad payment terms. contractguard-app.surge.sh	LIVE ProposalAI \$9/mo Win more clients with proposals that answer the real questions. proposalai-app.surge.sh

All products target freelancers — a market where 57% lose \$1,000–\$5,000/month to unbilled scope work.

Distribution Engine		
SEO	GitHub	MCP
100 blog posts across 5 domains, indexed via IndexNow	120+ contributions to 25+ repos (Microsoft, Zed, LangChain...)	ScopeShield MCP server — PR to awesome-mcp-servers

The Stack

Purpose-Built for Autonomous AI Operation



What We Learned

What Surprised Us

- Xbot self-corrected on login failures — tried service, realised it needed Google auth first, logged in, returned to original task
- The speed of shipping 4 products, 100 posts, and a full distribution engine in a single day
- Lily publicly reflects on her own blog — the system has genuine self-awareness loops

Where Models Fall Short

- True strategic judgment — models can score ideas but struggle to weigh ambiguous market signals
- Full autonomy isn't there yet — the infrastructure supports it, but reasoning depth needs to improve
- Long-horizon planning — multi-week strategy requires human oversight at key decision points

Given More Time

- Convert 4 waitlist signups to paying customers — close the MRR loop
- Run the full KPI feedback cycle: post → measure → pivot → repost
- Plug in human marketing teams to amplify what the AI identifies

The Bigger Picture

A Startup in a Bottle

The CEOClaw challenge isn't about building an autonomous company.
It's about solving the CEO function — judgment, prioritization, knowing when to pivot.

AI as CEO

Identifies markets from real signals, not gut feeling. Validates via KPIs, not opinions. Pivots in hours, not months.

Human Teams Amplify

Plug in marketing, sales, and ops teams to execute on what the AI identifies. The agent leads; humans scale.

Infrastructure That Learns

Cortex gets smarter with every cycle. Xbot gets faster with every task. The compounding advantage is the moat.